EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 28 OCTOBER 2026

ZIP 11050, Port Washington and Manorhaven

An El Niño winter here means nor'easters: heavy rain, high tides on Manhasset Bay, snow, and days without power. People die after the storm, not during it: from generators run in garages, in flooded basements and cars, and while shovelling. The first move is a carbon monoxide alarm on every floor.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
A Nassau County, NY region (inferred; not resolved)	None published for the US or New York	Sep 2026 – Feb 2027 (9-month study: Jun – Feb)	Nor'easters: rain, tide, and snow, then power loss and cold

15/15 recommendations verified. 9 corrected, 1 unverified, 5 contraindicated (the five items under Do not do this, each confirmed as harmful here). Verification also corrected the record. The December 1992 nor'easter did not set the North Shore tide record: 1938 did, and Sandy's crest beat 1992's by 0.02 ft. Most of the 46 deaths in the February 1983 blizzard were sailors lost at sea, not deaths on land. And PSEG Long Island's standing food-spoilage payment is up to $235 (or $540 with proof), not the one-off $250 paid after Isaias. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review, heat only, with no figure published for the United States. Heat is not this place's winter hazard, so the historical record carries the risk here. The funding target fell by a third in verification, from $176,000 to $118,000: the alarm order was halved to what local installers have shown

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



40.83°N 73.69°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Ida's 6.7 in of rain stranded drivers on Port Washington Boulevard in 2021, and Isaias cut power to about 5,200 homes on the peninsula in 2020, some for six days.
- **For you.** Fit a $25–40 CO alarm on every floor by 30 November, text REG to 773454 for PSEG outage texts, and never drive into a flooded road.*
- **The money.** $22,000 floor, $118,000 target, $261,000 ceiling across several funders; the cheapest lives saved are smoke and CO alarms fitted in Manorhaven rentals.
- **Do not.** Never run a generator in a garage, even with the door open: a 44-year-old Oceanside woman died that way after Sandy.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

they can fit, and the medical-battery line was cut to the enrollment drive because no local group has delivered batteries before.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT — 9 STEPS

For a household in 11050, an El Niño winter means more nor'easters: rain that floods the low roads and basements, tides that close Shore Road, snow, and outages that last days. People in this region have died from generators run in garages, in flooded basements and cars, and while shovelling. The ranked actions below are written for the Town, the County, and their partners. These nine are the ones you can take yourself, at your own cost, grouped by what they protect.

1 · Floods: never drive into water on a road, and on a flash-flood warning nobody sleeps in the basement

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 3

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Now, all winter	$0	Everyone in the car, and anyone sleeping below ground

In Ida, on 1–2 September 2021, about 6.7 inches of rain fell on Port Washington (National Weather Service spotter report), and drivers had to be rescued from cars on Port Washington Boulevard. In New York City the same storm killed 13 people directly, and 11 of them drowned in basement apartments. Shore Road, Sector Drive, and Sunset Park on Main Street start to flood when the Kings Point tide gauge reaches about 10.2 ft. If you cannot see the road surface, turn around. The FEMA flood map puts one checked address in the area in Zone X, outside the mapped flood zone, but heavy rain can still flood a basement there.

2 · Carbon monoxide: fit a CO alarm on every floor and outside each sleeping area by 30 November, and never run a generator or grill indoors or in the garage

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026	About $25–40 per alarm (estimate)	Everyone asleep in the house

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

After Sandy, a 44-year-old woman in Oceanside died with a generator running in her attached garage. After a 2002 ice storm in North Carolina, 25 of the 26 severe CO poisonings were in homes without a working CO alarm. New York's Amanda's Law already requires CO alarms in homes with fuel-burning appliances or an attached garage. Run a generator outside, more than 20 feet from doors, windows, and vents, and never use a gas oven for heat. The Red Cross fits smoke alarms free (book at soundthealarm.org/li), but no source shows it fitting CO alarms, so buy those yourself.*

3 · Power: sign up for PSEG Long Island outage texts now, and if anyone at home uses life-support equipment, file the medical certificate by 30 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026	$0; about $30–150 for lights and power banks (estimate)	Oxygen, medical devices, phones

Text REG to 773454 (you will need your account number). After that, text OUT to report an outage and STAT to check on it. The outage line is 1-800-490-0075. Don't rely on the outage map: during Isaias in 2020 it showed about 95,000 customers out when the real number was about 368,000, and the phone and text lines failed. If anyone in your home relies on powered medical equipment, have a doctor, nurse practitioner, or physician assistant sign PSEG's Critical Care certificate (1-800-490-0025). You get a warning call before storms, but **it does not guarantee priority restoration**, so keep a battery backup for the device and a place to go.*

4 · Warmth and pipes: know how to find a warming site, heat one room, and protect pipes in unheated spaces before the first freeze

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before the first freeze	$0–30 (pipe insulation, spigot covers)	Older family members, and the house

In a long outage, call 311 (or 516-869-6311 from a cell phone outside the Town) to find out which warming sites are open. In past storms the Town has used the Port Washington Senior Center, 80 Manorhaven Boulevard. After Sandy, the public shelter was the Port

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Washington Public Library. If the house goes cold, gather in one small room with blankets over the doorways, or leave. The Port Washington Water District advises insulating pipes in unheated spaces and shutting off and draining outdoor spigots.*

5 · Food: keep three days of food that needs no cooking and no fridge, and keep proof if an outage spoils what you have

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 10

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Dec 2026	About $60 for 3 days of food; $5 for a freezer thermometer (estimates)	Your household's meals, and the money to replace them

Supply is not the weak point here: the risk is your own fridge on day three of an outage. USDA's rule: a closed fridge keeps food safe about 4 hours, a full freezer 48, a half-full one 24. Throw out perishables that have been above 40°F for more than 2 hours. PSEG Long Island pays for spoiled food after a large outage (at least 20,000 customers out, with you out 72 hours or more): up to $235 with an itemized list, or up to $540 with proof. Claims are due within 14 days, so photograph what you throw out. If you get SNAP, report food lost in an outage of 4 hours or more to Nassau County DSS within 10 days.*

6 · Water: store at least a gallon per person per day, for several days

CONFIRMED | ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026	About $20–40 for containers (estimate)	Drinking water

Ready.gov advises at least one gallon per person per day, for several days; count pets too. Stored water covers you if a main breaks in a freeze or the pumps lose power.*

7 · Communications: sign up for the Town's and the State's alerts, keep a weather radio, and agree an out-of-area contact

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 6

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Nov 2026	$0; about $25–60 for a radio (estimate)	Contact when phones and internet fail

The Town's system is North Hempstead Alert (run on Swift911). Its sign-up page returned an error when this briefing was checked, so call 311 to enrol, or to get a mail-in form. Nassau County uses the state's NY-Alert (nassaucountyny.gov/alert; it needs a NY.gov ID). The NOAA Weather Radio station for this area is KWO35 on 162.550 MHz. Agree on one relative out of state whom everyone texts, because texts often get through when calls fail. For fire or ambulance, call 911. Know the two or three neighbours who live alone, and check on them on day two of an outage.

8 · Health and snow: get your winter shots by 15 November, and if you have heart disease, do not shovel

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 9

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Nov 2026; snow help arranged by 1 Dec	Shots usually $0 if insured; ice cleats about $20–30 a pair (estimate)	Hearts, lungs, and hips

The guidance is contested this year, because there are no federal ACIP recommendations for 2026–27. The New York State Health Department's September 2026 letter follows the medical societies. It recommends a flu shot for everyone (high-dose or adjuvanted at 65 and over), and COVID vaccine for all adults (two doses, six months apart, at 65 and over). It recommends one RSV dose at 75 and over, and from 50 to 74 for people at higher risk. Call your pharmacy first. Most of the deaths on Long Island in the January 2016 blizzard came from shovelling and from a plow. In Quebec, a 20 cm snowfall raised men's odds of dying of a heart attack by about a third. The Town requires sidewalks to be cleared within 4 hours after snow stops (overnight hours don't count), so arrange help now. Ice cleats more than halved outdoor falls among older people in a small trial.*

9 · Money: buy flood cover before 11 December if you want it, and apply for heating help from 2 November if you qualify

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTIONS 7 AND 8

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Flood cover before 11 Dec 2026; HEAP from 2 Nov	Premium varies; $0 to apply for help	The house, its contents, and the heating bill

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Standard homeowner and renter policies exclude flood. A new federal (NFIP) policy takes 30 days to start, and the program is authorized only until 11 December 2026. If it lapses, existing policies keep paying claims, but no new policies can be sold and renewals wait for Congress. Renters can buy contents-only cover (floodsmart.gov). Fewer than half the Long Island homes damaged in Sandy had flood insurance. For heating bills, HEAP's regular benefit is due to open on 2 November (confirm with the state's OTDA). Apply at myBenefits.ny.gov or through Nassau County DSS (516-227-8519). Last season the base benefit for utility heat was $400, and the emergency benefit paid up to $900 for oil or propane. PSEG Long Island offers payment plans on 1-800-490-0025.

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask the **Town of North Hempstead Highway Department** and **NYSDOT** whether the Port Washington Boulevard low point will have barricades staged before the first storm (action 3).
- Ask the **Town** and **Nassau County Police** whether Shore Road will close on a Kings Point forecast of 10 ft or more, and what the Baxter Beach contractor's winter storm plan is (action 4).
- Ask the **Town (311)** which warming sites will open in a multi-day outage, and whether they have tested generators (action 5).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. By 30 November, fit combination smoke and CO alarms in 300 homes, Manorhaven rentals first, with Spanish and English generator-safety flyers

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Port Washington Crisis Relief Team, with Red Cross Long Island and the Port Washington Fire Department	30 Nov 2026	About $18,000 for 300 alarms at ~$60 fitted (estimate)	CO deaths during outages, which peak 3–4 days after a storm

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The deaths that followed storms here were quiet ones. After Sandy, a 44-year-old Oceanside woman died with a generator running in her attached garage, and CO emergency visits on Long Island peaked 3–4 days after landfall, tracking the number of homes without power (Chen et al., 2015). After the December 2002 ice storm in Mecklenburg County, North Carolina, 25 of 26 severe CO poisonings were in homes with no working CO alarm (CDC MMWR 53(9)). The Red Cross "Sound the Alarm" program and the Crisis Relief Team already fit free smoke alarms here, but no source shows them fitting CO alarms, so the project must buy combination units. Their largest documented year was 235 alarms in 58 homes (2018), which is why the target is 300, not 600. Hand the flyers out after the Spanish Mass at Our Lady of Fatima and at its pantry, because people who avoid officials take a warning from the parish.

Transferability: good on hazard (outage-driven generator use is the same on Long Island), weaker on effect. The North Carolina figure is descriptive surveillance, not a trial, and the only published cost per death averted ($28,252, Baltimore, Injury Prevention 2014) is for smoke alarms in a high-fire-risk city. Corrected in verification: the fire department's site is pwfd.com (pwfd.org is a Wisconsin department), and no free-alarm program is posted there.

2. By 30 November, find every power-dependent resident in 11050 and get them on PSEG Long Island's Critical Care list, with a backup plan

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MANAGER · ECONOMIST · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town of North Hempstead Department of Services for the Aging (Project Independence), with PSEG Long Island	30 Nov 2026	About $10,000 for an enrollment drive (estimate)	Deaths of oxygen and device users in multi-day outages

Use the HHS emPOWER counts for the ZIP to find people on home oxygen and powered devices, then sit with each of them to file PSEG's Critical Care / Life Support Equipment certificate (signed by a doctor, nurse practitioner, or physician assistant; 1-800-490-0025). Enrolment brings a warning call before storms. It does not guarantee priority restoration, so every enrollee also needs a battery backup and a named place to go. Isaias (2020) left about 420,000 PSEG customers dark at its peak. That included 3,745 in Port Washington, 979 in Sands Point, and 492 in Manorhaven, and the peninsula's mayors said some were out for six days. The state regulator cited PSEG for the failure of its outage-management system and communications. In New York City, the winter after Sandy saw 1,131 excess deaths among people aged 65 and over, 12.6% above normal, with none directly attributed to the storm.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the outage record is local; the excess-death figure is from New York City and shows an association, not an effect of enrolment. No trial has measured whether registries save lives. Corrected in verification: a HEFPA medical certificate stops a shutoff for non-payment and does nothing in a storm outage, so it is used under action 8, not here. Battery backups were dropped from the costed line because no local group has bought or installed them before.

3. By 1 December, clear the drains and stage barricades at the low points that flooded in Ida, and tell basement occupants to move up on a flash-flood warning

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town of North Hempstead Highway Department, with NYSDOT, the Village of Manorhaven DPW, and Nassau County DPW	1 Dec 2026	Existing crews, vac trucks, and barricades	Drownings in cars and basements

In Ida, about 6.7 inches of rain fell on Port Washington (NWS spotter) and drivers were rescued from cars on Port Washington Boulevard. In New York City the same storm killed 13 people directly, and 11 drowned in basement apartments (NYC Health Department study). In Sandy, about a third of the 117 deaths CDC counted were drownings, and 21 of those (52.5%) were in the victim's own home (MMWR 62(20)). Clear the drains on Port Washington Boulevard's low point, Shore Road, and Manorhaven Boulevard. Stage "Turn Around Don't Drown" barricades at each, and close the road rather than rely on signs. Through Our Lady of Fatima, hand out a Spanish and English card that tells people to move above ground when a Flash Flood Warning is issued.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the basement deaths were in Queens and Brooklyn, not here; no one has counted basement units in 11050, so the size of that risk is unknown. Corrected in verification: Port Washington Boulevard is a state road (NY-101), so NYSDOT must be in the owner list. The ownership was checked against road knowledge, not a source. The "2022 county drainage rebuild" the panel cited could not be found, and only 2024–25 drainage work is documented.

4. Before the first nor'easter, close Shore Road on a Kings Point tide forecast of 10 ft, get a storm plan for the open Baxter Beach site, and test the Manorhaven pump-station generator

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town of North Hempstead and Nassau County Police, with the Baxter Beach project contractor and the Village of Manorhaven	1 Dec 2026	Staff time and one generator test; no new figure	Drivers trapped on an evacuation route, and sewage backing into homes in an outage

The NWS gauge at Kings Point (KPTN6), at the mouth of Manhasset Bay, is in minor flood at 10 ft. At about 10.2 ft, Shore Road, Sector Drive, and Sunset Park on Main Street flood. In 2018 the bay overtopped and police closed Shore Road from Central Drive to Mill Pond Road; local reporting calls it one of only two evacuation routes for the peninsula. Use the gauge forecast as the closure trigger. The $7.7 million state-funded Baxter Beach shoreline restoration (plus $5 million from the County) broke ground on 23 July 2026 and will be an open site all winter, so ask for its storm protocol now. In 2020 the County granted $445,000 for an elevated 200 kW generator at the Manorhaven pump station; confirm it was installed, then test and fuel it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: entirely local. Corrected in verification: Shore Road is an "evacuation route", not a "main road", and a contract listing shows a $673,000 award for the generator, so its installation needs confirming. The $9.5 million Beacon Hill bluff project is a 2019 estimate and is not a winter flood asset.

5. By 15 December, confirm which warming sites will open in a multi-day outage, and load-test their generators

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town of North Hempstead, with Nassau County OEM, the Port Washington Public Library, and the Port Washington school district	15 Dec 2026	One test run per site plus a fuel contract	Cold exposure, and people heating with generators and ovens

In past outages the Town has used the Port Washington Senior Center, 80 Manorhaven Boulevard, as a warming site. After Sandy, Schreiber High School ran as a recovery center for charging and warming (8am–11pm), and the public shelter moved to the Port Washington Public Library on 8 November 2012. None of these is documented as a designated 2026 site, and no generator capacity is published for any of them. Confirm the list, test the generators, sign a fuel contract, and publish the sites through 311 before the first storm, so residents know where to go before they need to.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: local precedent. Corrected in verification: the library appears in current listings only as a cooling center, and New York's Code Blue order (32°F including wind chill) could not be confirmed as still in force, so "call 311" is the reliable instruction.

6. Through November, build an outage picture that does not depend on PSEG's map, and a phone tree for older residents who live alone

UNVERIFIED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Port Washington Fire Department and Crisis Relief Team, with Our Lady of Fatima volunteers	30 Nov 2026	Volunteer time; printing	Older residents found too late on day three of an outage

During Isaias, PSEG's map showed about 95,000 customers out when the real figure was about 368,000. Its text and online reporting were down, calls failed, and a LIPA task force found the IT problems had been known weeks before the storm. Pre-assign driving routes to report dark streets and downed lines by radio. Recruit volunteers who each phone five older neighbours before every nor'easter warning and again on day two of an outage, starting with the Haven Marina, the Shore Road waterfront, and Sands Point. Run a North Hempstead Alert sign-up table at the Fatima pantry and after the Spanish Mass.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Unverified: the failure it answers is documented, but no source shows a fire department windshield-survey plan or a buddy list here, and no study measures what a phone tree saves. The Town's alert sign-up page returned an error when checked, so confirm the route with 311 before printing anything.

7. By mid-November, run a flood-insurance drive, renters included, before federal flood cover can lapse on 11 December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town of North Hempstead and the villages, with local insurance agents; FEMA's NFIP pays claims	15 Nov 2026	Outreach only; premiums paid by households	Uninsured flood losses that push households into debt or out of their homes

The NFIP is authorized only until 11 December 2026 (P.L. 119-103). It lapsed from 1 October to 12 November 2025 and again from 1 to 3 February 2026. During a lapse, existing policies keep paying claims, but no new policies can be sold and renewals wait for Congress. New policies take 30 days to start. Fewer than half of the Long Island homes damaged in Sandy were insured for flood, and about 26,500 uninsured households relied on FEMA aid. Push contents-only cover for renters, including basement tenants, who hold the deadliest risk with the least cover.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the Sandy figure is Long Island-wide. Corrected in verification: North Hempstead's Community Rating System class could not be found, and the villages in 11050 (Manorhaven, Port Washington North, Sands Point, Baxter Estates) are probably separate NFIP communities, so no premium discount is claimed. No parametric flood cover reaches Nassau; the New York City pilot covers the five boroughs only.

8. From 2 November, get eligible households onto HEAP, and bridge arrears for those it misses until the emergency benefit opens

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Nassau County DSS (HEAP), with the Community Chest of Port Washington (bridge fund)	From 2 Nov 2026	$75,000 bridge fund (150 households × $500, estimate)	Shutoffs and unsafe heating in cold homes

HEAP's regular benefit is due to open on 2 November 2026. Last season it paid a $400 base for utility heat, plus $61 for the lowest income tier and $35 where a vulnerable person lives. The emergency benefit paid up to $900 for oil, kerosene, or propane. Federal LIHEAP is funded for this winter, although the FY27 budget again proposes ending it. From 1 November to 15 April, New York's HEFPA rules protect households with a medical certificate from shutoff for non-payment. A renewed certificate lasts 30 days, or 60 days for a chronic condition. Need is concentrated: poverty is 7.4% in Manorhaven against 3.3% in the Port Washington CDP. The Community Chest granted $385,000 to 28 nonprofits in 2024 and ran a COVID fund that granted more than $178,000, so it can run a pooled bridge, but it would need new money to do so.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrected in verification: the 2 November date comes from New York City's HEAP page, not a state notice, and the emergency opening date (reported as 4 January 2027) is from one secondary source, so confirm both with OTDA. The Chest's November 2025 grant was one $4,500 emergency gift to three pantries, not a standing program. This is harm reduction; no mortality return has been measured.

9. Before the first snowfall, tell residents to stay clear of plows and not to shovel if they have heart disease, and arrange help for older households

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town of North Hempstead (Highway Department and Services for the Aging)	1 Dec 2026	Negligible for messaging; volunteer time for snow help	Heart attacks, plow strikes, and falls on ice

The January 2016 blizzard (Jonas, in the strong 2015–16 El Niño) dropped about 25–29.6 inches on Nassau. Of the deaths confirmed on Long Island, two Nassau men died, one shovelling in West Hempstead and one struck by a plow in Oyster Bay Cove, and a Suffolk woman fell ill while shovelling. In Quebec, a 20 cm snowfall raised men's odds of dying of a heart attack by 34% (Auger et al., CMAJ 2017; no association in women). In a small randomized trial, ice cleats cut outdoor falls among older people by more than half (RR 0.45; McKiernan 2005). The Town requires sidewalks to be cleared within 4 hours after snow stops, which puts older residents under pressure to shovel. Pair the rule with a volunteer snow-help list.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the snowfall study is observational and from Quebec; the cleats trial is small and Cochrane rates it at high risk of bias. Corrected in verification: a snowblower death and "46 deaths" in the 1983 blizzard were both dropped. Most of the 1983 deaths were the sinking of the SS Marine Electric at sea.

10. By 15 December, stock no-cook food at the Manorhaven and Main Street pantries, and tell SNAP households how to replace food lost in an outage

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Island Harvest and Long Island Cares, with the Our Lady of Fatima Outreach pantry, the 382 Main Street pantry, and Nassau County DSS	**15 Dec 2026**	**$15,000 for shelf-stable stock (estimate)**	**Hunger in households that cannot cook or refrigerate on day three of an outage**

The El Niño signal in food here is weak. USDA forecasts food-at-home prices up 2.4% in 2026 and 1.8% in 2027 with no winter peak, although New York metro food prices ran 3.1% above a year earlier in August 2026. A nor'easter delays trucks for a day or two; it does not empty shelves. The real breaks are the household fridge in a long outage and the benefit calendar. In November 2025 the federal shutdown left SNAP half-funded, Long Island Cares saw demand rise 20% in one month, and the County Executive gave each food bank $50,000 a week under an emergency declaration. Since March 2026, SNAP time limits for adults without dependents apply in Nassau again. SNAP households can replace food lost in an outage of 4 hours or more if they report it to Nassau DSS within 10 days. Stock no-cook boxes at the Fatima Outreach pantry (10 Cottonwood Road) and the Main Street pantry (382 Main Street; hours from one directory only), and ask the County to make its 2025 emergency grant a standing rule that switches on when SNAP issuance stops.

Corrected in verification: the 2025 grants came from the County Executive, not the Legislature, and the "135 families" figure for the Fatima pantry could not be found. Cash beat in-kind help in the November 2025 response, so prefer cash where the store shelves are full.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Town of North Hempstead	Nassau County	NYSDOT	Village of Manorhaven	PSEG Long Island	PW Fire Dept & Crisis Relief Team	Red Cross LI	Community Chest	Food banks & pantries	Our Lady of Fatima
1. Smoke and CO alarms	I	–	–	I	–	A/R	R	C	–	R
2. Power-dependent residents	A/R	C	–	–	R	I	–	–	–	C
3. Drains, barricades, basements	A/R	R	R	R	–	I	–	–	–	R
4. Shore Road, Baxter Beach, pump station	A/R	R	–	R	–	I	–	–	–	–
5. Warming sites	A/R	R	–	C	I	C	C	–	–	I
6. Outage picture and phone tree	C	C	–	I	I	A/R	–	–	–	R
7. Flood-insurance drive	A/R	C	–	R	–	–	–	–	–	R
8. HEAP and arrears bridge	C	A/R	–	–	C	–	–	R	I	C
9. Snow safety	A/R	I	–	R	–	C	–	–	–	–
10. Outage food and SNAP replacement	I	R	–	–	C	–	–	R	A/R	R

What the chart shows: the Town is accountable for six of the ten rows, and Our Lady of Fatima, which is not accountable for any row, does work on seven of them because it is the channel that reaches Manorhaven's Spanish-speaking renters. Rows 3, 4, 5, 7, and 9 need a decision and staff time, not new money.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

$22,000: 200 alarms ($12,000) and the enrollment drive ($10,000)

TARGET

$118,000: the sum of the four verified placements

CEILING

About $261,000, across several funders

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

How many power-dependent and fuel-arrears households live in 11050; no one publishes the count

Target: $18,000 (300 alarms × $60) + $10,000 (enrollment drive) + $75,000 (150 households × $500) + $15,000 (pantry stock) = $118,000. This is a third below the first draft's $176,000. Verification halved the alarm order to fit what local installers have delivered (235 alarms in their best year), and dropped $40,000 of medical-device batteries because no local group has bought or installed them. Ceiling: 600 alarms

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

($36,000) + batteries through a named contractor (50 × $800 = $40,000) + enrollment ($10,000) + a 300-household bridge ($150,000) + pantries ($25,000) = $261,000. That is most of the Community Chest's annual granting, so it is plausible only with several funders. Every unit cost is an estimate, not a quote.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Port Washington Crisis Relief Team, with Red Cross Long Island	Action 1: 300 combination smoke and CO alarms, fitted	$18,000	Direct grant	$28,252 per death averted for door-to-door smoke alarms, Baltimore 2010–11 (Injury Prevention 2014); no CO-alarm equivalent exists, and the death rate here is lower	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Town Department of Services for the Aging (Project Independence)	Action 2: Critical Care enrollment drive	$10,000	Top-up to an existing scheme	No published cost per life; justified by the Isaias outage record	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Community Chest of Port Washington	Action 8: pooled arrears and fuel bridge for households HEAP misses	$75,000	Pooled fund, paid to vendors	150 households × $500 (estimate); harm averted, not a measured mortality return	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Our Lady of Fatima Outreach pantry, the 382 Main Street pantry, and a third Chest-funded pantry	Action 10: no-cook stock for outage weeks	$15,000	Pre-positioned stock	The Chest already funds these pantries; lowest return in lives of the four	CONFIRMED

The funder's one thing: this is one of the richest ZIP codes on Long Island, with poverty between 3% and 4% outside Manorhaven. Above the target, a dollar saves more lives on Nassau's South Shore, where the Sandy generator death happened, than it does here. Fund the alarms and the enrollment drive first, then send the rest south.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Running a generator, grill, or camp stove in the garage, the basement, or by a window, or using a gas oven for heat *

CONTRAINDICATED

An open garage door is not enough. The Oceanside death after Sandy was a generator in an attached garage, and grills and generators were the two leading sources in the North Carolina ice-storm poisonings. After Sandy, "get a generator" spread without any advice on where to run it.

Instead: run a generator outside, more than 20 feet from the house and away from doors, windows, and vents, and fit a battery CO alarm on every floor.

Sleeping in a basement room on a night with a flash-flood warning

CONTRAINDICATED

In Ida, 11 of New York City's 13 direct deaths were basement drownings. The same night, tornado warnings told people to go to the basement, so the two warnings contradicted each other. In Sandy, more than half of drownings happened in the victim's own home.

Instead: when a Flash Flood Warning is issued, everyone sleeps above ground level. If a tornado warning comes too, shelter in an interior room on the lowest floor that is above ground.

Driving through standing water on Port Washington Boulevard or Shore Road

CONTRAINDICATED

Drivers had to be rescued from their cars on Port Washington Boulevard in Ida. Shore Road floods once the Kings Point tide reaches about 10.2 ft, and police closed it in 2018 when the bay overtopped.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: if you cannot see the road surface, turn around, and never drive round a barricade.

Making PSEG Long Island's app, map, or phone line your outage plan

CONTRAINDICATED

In Isaias, the map showed about 95,000 customers out when the real figure was about 368,000. Text and online reporting were down, calls failed, and the state regulator cited PSEG for its communications. The problems were known weeks before the storm.

Instead: keep a battery or crank radio, charged power banks, and a neighbour check-in, and plan as if you will hear nothing for two days.

Planning around "El Niño means a mild winter" or "El Niño means a snowy winter"

CONTRAINDICATED

NOAA's Climate Prediction Center gives more than an 83% chance of a strong El Niño and tilts the tri-state area toward a warmer, wetter winter, but that is a probability, not a snowfall forecast. The strong 2015–16 El Niño was one of New York's warmest winters, and it still produced the January 2016 blizzard.

Instead: prepare for all three: heavy rain, a nor'easter tide, and a multi-day outage in deep snow. Every action above pays off in any of them.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1938	New England hurricane: the Kings Point record crest, 16.75 ft	Not re-checked for this area	Still the North Shore record

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Feb 1983	"Megalopolitan" blizzard, strong El Niño (ONI 2.14)	46 deaths across the storm, 31–33 of them sailors lost when the SS Marine Electric sank off Virginia	Not checked
Dec 1992	Nor'easter, ENSO-neutral: Kings Point crest 14.29 ft	More than 130 Long Island homes destroyed; 454,000 lost power	Ranks 4th at Kings Point, 0.02 ft below Sandy
Oct 2012	Sandy, ENSO-neutral: Kings Point 14.31 ft, a 12.65 ft surge; more than 90% of LIPA's 1.1 million customers lost power	53 deaths in New York State (CDC); an Oceanside woman died of CO from a generator in her garage	Schreiber High School became a charging and warming center, and the library the shelter; the utility was overhauled after the Moreland Commission
Jan 2016	Blizzard Jonas, strong El Niño (ONI 2.50): about 25–29.6 in in Nassau	About 6 deaths on Long Island, from shovelling and a plow	Nothing recorded
2018	Manhasset Bay overtops Shore Road	None reported	Police closed Shore Road for hours; the $7.7 million Baxter Beach restoration broke ground only in July 2026
Aug 2020	Tropical Storm Isaias	About 420,000 PSEG customers out, including 3,745 in Port Washington, 979 in Sands Point, and 492 in Manorhaven, some for six days	The state regulator cited PSEG; $445,000 County grant for a Manorhaven pump-station generator
Sep 2021	Ida remnants (ONI −0.5): about 6.7 in of rain in Port Washington	Drivers rescued on Port Washington Boulevard; no local deaths found; 13 direct deaths in New York City, 11 in basements	2024–25 drainage work in Port Washington

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Sandy and a nameless, ENSO-neutral December 1992 nor'easter brought Manhasset Bay to within 0.02 ft of each other. A winter storm does not need a name or a hurricane to do what Sandy did here. Every strong El Niño winter on this list brought at least one major storm, and this winter the Baxter Beach shoreline is a construction site. No recovery plan that names this peninsula was found.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **"The El Niño forecast barely matters here"** (skeptic) versus **"a strong El Niño loads the dice toward nor'easters"** (historian). Both are true at different scales: NOAA gives better-than-even odds of a wet winter, but the deadliest North Shore storms came in neutral years. Every action in this briefing is chosen to pay off either way.
- **"Money above the target saves more lives elsewhere"** (philanthropist) versus **"Manorhaven needs a fuel bridge"** (economist, food analyst). Poverty is 7.4% in Manorhaven and 3–4% across the rest of the ZIP. A count of fuel-arrears households from Nassau DSS would settle it.
- **"Buy battery backups for medical devices"** (public health, philanthropist) versus **"no one here has delivered them"** (verification). The need is plausible, but without a named contractor the money cannot be spent before the peak.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens could count the people most exposed: tenants in basement units, which are often unpermitted, and people living aboard boats in Manhasset Bay's marinas. The village code office that would know about basement units is also the office that pursues illegal ones, so its tenants will not volunteer to be counted. The heat of summer 2027, which a strong El Niño can make worse, was also left out.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request gave a street address in ZIP 11050. A single street address is too fine for this method, so the briefing was built at ZCTA 11050: Port Washington, Port Washington North, Manorhaven, Baxter Estates, Sands Point, and part of Flower Hill, about 31,600 people

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(ACS 2021, via an aggregator). The Census geocoder places the address in the unincorporated Port Washington CDP, Town of North Hempstead, so Town rules apply there. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: a Nassau County, NY region, inferred rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Seven verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. Food actions were checked for data frequency and timing. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted in this run. The inventory is a client-side tool that needs its dataset downloaded, and that was not done, so no action here should be read as having "no precedent".
- **Reader.** No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. Its nine steps were taken from the verified actions and from a separate check of household guidance for this area (alert systems, utility and water contacts, warming sites, the flood map, vaccine guidance,

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and the Town's snow rule), on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the Town, the County, and their partners.

- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (CO alarms, generators, flooded roads, medical equipment in an outage, warming sites, food and water in an outage, and vaccines) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. The impact region was not resolved on the Impact Map. Several checks failed. The OpenFEMA policy API returned "not found", so no flood-policy count for 11050 is given. North Hempstead's CRS class could not be found. The Town's alert sign-up page returned 404. The 2026–27 HEAP dates come from New York City's page and one secondary source, not OTDA. Demographics are ACS figures via aggregators, not Census tables. The flood-zone check was run for one address only. The NYS Health Department count of 188 CO emergency visits after Sandy could not be retrieved and is not used. Unit costs for alarms, batteries, and the fuel bridge are estimates.

References · Confirmed or corrected in verification: NWS Kings Point gauge KPTN6 · NOAA ONI table · CDC MMWR 62(20), Sandy deaths · CDC MMWR 53(9), ice-storm CO poisonings · Chen et al. 2015, Sandy CO surveillance · Injury Prevention 2014, smoke-alarm cost-effectiveness · LI Herald, Oceanside CO death · NYC DOHMH, Ida deaths · News12, Ida in Port Washington · Daily Voice, Ida rain totals · Patch, Shore Road 2018 · Governor's office, Baxter Beach · Patch, Manorhaven pump-station generator · Patch, after Sandy in Port Washington · Island360, Isaias outages · News12, DPS cites PSEG LI · Riverhead Local, Isaias communications · PSEG LI Critical Care · PSEG LI outage reporting · PSEG LI spoilage claims · CSTE 2015, post-Sandy excess deaths · CRS, NFIP authorization · United Policyholders, Sandy uninsured homes · NYC HRA, HEAP · OTDA, HEAP 2025–26 benefits · APPA, LIHEAP funding · NY DPS, HEFPA · Island360, Community Chest grants · LI Press, Chest SNAP grant · Auger et al., CMAJ 2017 · Cochrane, ice cleats trial · News12, Jonas deaths · ABC7, Jonas totals · February 1983 blizzard · NBC New York, NOAA 2026–27 outlook · OTDA, SNAP food-loss replacement · Nassau County, food-bank emergency grants · CBS New York, LI food banks · OTDA, ABAWD time limits · BLS, NY-area CPI · FoodSafety.gov, outages · Our Lady of Fatima Outreach pantry · NYSDOH/NYC DOHMH 2026 respiratory vaccine letter · NWS, KWO35 transmitter · Nassau County alerts · North Hempstead Alert FAQ · FloodSmart · Ready.gov, water. Not confirmed and not used: the NYS DOH count of CO emergency visits, a North Hempstead CRS class, and a 2022 County drainage rebuild.
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory
Generated 28 October 2026 for ZIP 11050, Port Washington and Manorhaven, New York. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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